

SETBACK AND LESSONS LEARNED

Every real experiment runs into something. Recording it honestly is part of the science, and judges ask about it directly.

WHAT WENT WRONG

WHEN I NOTICED, AND HOW

WHAT I THINK CAUSED IT

WHAT I CHANGED, AND THE DATE I CHANGED IT

WHAT I WOULD DO DIFFERENTLY IF I STARTED OVER

SETBACKS BELONG IN YOUR PROJECT, NOT HIDDEN FROM IT

Judges ask what you would change if you did it again. A student who can describe a real problem and how they responded to it demonstrates deeper understanding than one whose project went perfectly. Copy your answer here into the discussion section of your paper.

COMMON SETBACKS, AND WHAT THEY USUALLY MEAN

Results varied wildly between trials

Something you thought was controlled probably was not. List every variable again.

Nothing measurable happened

Your independent variable may need a wider range between conditions.

You ran out of time

Note the extra time you had to spend. That's not bad, but the extra time spent